# Returns, Credit Notes and Product Recalls Policy

Document HPD-POL-001, version 3.0, effective 2026-01-01.

## 1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines when Helix Pharma Distribution (Helix) accepts products back from customers, how the value of accepted returns is credited, and how product recalls are handled. It applies to every customer that buys from Helix: pharmacies, hospitals and clinics. Sales representatives must not promise return conditions that differ from this policy without written approval from the Commercial Director.

## 2. Standard returns

Customers may return unopened and undamaged products within 14 calendar days of the delivery date. The return request must quote the invoice number and be submitted through the customer portal or to the customer's account manager.

- Returned products must have at least 6 months of remaining shelf life.
- Original outer packaging and tamper-evident seals must be intact.
- A restocking fee of 5% of the invoice value applies to returns that are not caused by a Helix error (for example, a customer ordering the wrong strength).
- Returns caused by a Helix error (wrong product, wrong quantity, damage in transit) are accepted without a restocking fee.

## 3. Cold-chain products

Products that must be stored between 2 and 8 °C (vaccines, insulin and biologic medicines) cannot be returned once the customer has accepted the delivery, because Helix cannot verify how they were stored after hand-over.

The only exception is a problem that exists at the moment of delivery. If the data logger shows a temperature excursion, or the product is visibly damaged, the customer must refuse the delivery, or report the problem within 24 hours of receipt together with a photo of the data logger reading. Such products are credited at 100% of the invoice value.

## 4. Near-expiry and expired products

Products that are within 3 months of their expiry date are accepted for a credit of 50% of the purchase price, provided they were bought from Helix within the last 12 months. Expired products are never accepted; the customer must destroy them according to the national regulations for pharmaceutical waste.

## 5. Credit notes

Approved returns are settled with a credit note against future invoices within 10 business days of Helix receiving the goods. Cash refunds are not given, except when the customer closes its account with Helix, in which case any remaining credit is paid by bank transfer within 30 days.

## 6. Product recalls

When a manufacturer or the regulator recalls a batch, Helix informs every customer that received that batch within 24 hours, by phone and by email. Customers must quarantine the affected stock immediately and return it within 7 calendar days. Recalled products are credited at 100% of the purchase price and no restocking fee applies. Helix keeps batch-level delivery records for 5 years so that every recall can be traced to customers.

## 7. Contacts

Returns desk: returns@helix-pharma.example, internal extension 214. Recall coordinator: quality@helix-pharma.example.